Certificate in Financial Planning: Economics majors

Advising one-pager · BS in Economics (Business), 2026-27 catalog · Gatton College, November 2026

Scan: how to add it

Which sheet? Wealth management or financial planning: CFP. Investment research or portfolio management: CFA. Investment banking or private equity: Investment Banking. Real estate lending, investment, or development: Real Estate. Students can combine them. All sheets: willgerken.com/roadmaps

What it is

Financial planners help people manage money across investments, taxes, retirement, insurance, and estates. Personal financial advisors earned a **median of $105,070** in 2025, according to the Bureau of Labor Statistics. The six courses satisfy the **education requirement** for CFP® certification; the exam, experience, and ethics requirements complete it. Open to any major, and full-time on-campus undergraduates add it in myGPS at **no additional tuition**. Each course needs a C or better. No business courses are needed first; only FIN 359 must come after the others.

The six courses

Area	Course	Offered	For an Economics major
Fundamentals	**FIN 350*** (or ACC 356, if already taken)	Fall, spring	free elective
Tax	**ACC 357**, or **ACC 407**†	ACC 357: fall only. ACC 407: fall, spring	free elective
Investment	**FIN 357**	Fall, spring	free elective
Estate	**ACC 457**	Fall, spring	free elective
Retirement	**FIN 358**	Fall, spring; no alternate course	free elective
Capstone	**FIN 359**	Fall, spring; taken last	free elective

* FIN 350 lists a 60-credit-hour prerequisite that can be waived: email the director. ACC 457's tax prerequisite is waived for certificate students.

The posted four-year plan, with the certificate on top

Year	Fall	Spring
Freshman	CIS 110, MA 109, UK Core ×3	CIS 111, MA 123, UK Core ×3
Sophomore	AN 105, ACC 200, ECO 201, STA 296, MKT 300, elective	ECO 202, ACC 201, MGT 301, MA 162, elective
Junior	ECO 401, FIN 300, ECO 391, **FIN 350***, **ACC 357**	ECO 402, AN 300, MGT 340, CIS 300, ECO 300-level
Senior	ECO 300-level ×2, **FIN 357**, **FIN 358**, **ACC 457**	ECO 400-level ×2, **FIN 359**, elective

Roadmap course **Counts for roadmap and major ✓** Major requirement UK Core, electives *Italic = recommended* One term only

The certificate takes **six of the plan's nine electives**, and three stay open. Every certificate course lands in an existing elective slot.

Spring start, or three terms left? FIN 350, FIN 357 in spring; ACC 357, ACC 457, FIN 358 in fall; FIN 359 last. Expect a heavier term.

Three things to know

1. **It fits in the electives.** Six of nine, with three still open.
2. **Take ACC 357 in a fall.** It is the one course that runs in a single term, so a student who reaches senior spring without it cannot finish before graduating (Executive Education afterward costs $895 a course).
3. **Save FIN 359 for last.** It is the capstone and runs both terms. Once ACC 357 has its fall, the other courses can go in either term.

After the certificate

- Students can sit for the CFP exam as soon as their completion is reported. Experience (6,000 hours, or 4,000 through an apprenticeship) and the bachelor's degree can follow the exam.
- Licenses depend on the job: Series 65 or 66 for RIA roles; SIE, Series 7, and 63 or 66 for broker-dealers; state life and health for insurance. We **recommend the SIE** for every student: it needs no sponsoring firm and is not required for the CFP.
- Get involved: the Finance Society's Financial Planning Pathway.

To add the certificate: talk with an advisor, then myUK → myGPS → My Program of Study → Request a Major Change → Add a Major, and search for Financial Planning (adds the certificate, not a second major). Details: gatton.uky.edu/certificate-financial-planning, or scan the code at top.

Terms. Free elective: any course the student chooses that counts toward graduation hours. SIE: Securities Industry Essentials, FINRA's entry-level exam. † **ACC 407: Accounting majors and double majors only.** Other majors take ACC 357 (fall only).

Director: Will Gerken, CFP®, will.gerken@uky.edu · Plan: posted 2026-27 Economics (Business) sample curriculum; the catalog year a student entered under governs.

A general guide, not official advising. Compiled from publicly posted UK catalog and curriculum pages; requirements change and no warranty is given. Confirm your plan with your academic advisor and your myUK GPS degree audit.